

Read the practice before redesigning the work.

The first month should create trust, operating clarity, and a shared factual map - not an imported AI agenda.

OBJECTIVES

Understand the mandate - Align with the Senior Director of AI on outcomes, decision rights, current commitments, and leadership reporting. - Clarify role boundaries with KM / Practice Technology, IT, Security, Risk, OGC, L&D, and Communications.	Read the practices - Shadow representative Corporate, Litigation, Regulatory, and White Collar work. - Listen for workarounds, first asks, underlying objectives, review burden, and client-service friction.	Develop the team - Establish one-on-ones, practice pairing, weekly delivery review, learning expectations, and escalation norms. - Inventory skills, capacity, active work, dependencies, and coaching needs.
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KEY WORK PRODUCTS BY DAY 30

WORK PRODUCT	PURPOSE	DECISION ENABLED
Applied AI demand map	Current and emerging use cases, sponsors, users, outcomes, dependencies, risk, and status.	What deserves attention now?
Workflow and knowledge map	Attorney work, source content, taxonomies, owners, privilege/access, and technical systems.	Where must AI and KM advance together?
Delivery baseline	Current intake, build, evaluation, release, enablement, support, metrics, and vendor paths.	Which mechanisms should be clarified first?
Stakeholder contract	Named decision rights and escalation among practices, AI, KM, Technology, Risk, and leadership.	Who decides, reviews, supports, and owns?

QUESTIONS THAT PREVENT PREMATURE PRESCRIPTION

- What client or matter outcome is actually constrained?
 - Where does attorney judgment add the most value?
 - Which knowledge source is authoritative and who maintains it?
- What would make a lawyer stop using the workflow?
 - What consequence changes the required review?
 - What evidence would justify broader reuse?

DAYS 31-60 - CONCENTRATE THE PORTFOLIO

Install a useful intake and sequencing mechanism

- Define the client-service outcome, eligible users, matter fit, data and knowledge readiness, consequence, sponsor, delivery owner, adoption owner, and value evidence.
- Use explicit dispositions: explore, queue, pilot, scale, hold, stop.
- Select a small portfolio that spans at least two practices but does not manufacture cross-practice reuse before evidence.

Agree before building

- AI role and retained lawyer authority.
- Approved sources, access, provenance, and knowledge owner.
- Task-specific evaluation and release conditions.
- Support, training, telemetry, and feedback path.

DAYS 61-90 - PROVE AND ENABLE

Ship bounded workflows into real work

- Pair each practice AI Manager with attorney sponsor, KM / Practice Technology counterpart, technical owner, and control reviewers.
- Prefer an accepted increment over a polished demonstration.
- Capture override, correction, abandonment, support, and exception signals.

Make adoption part of the product

- Run demos around attorney tasks, not model features.
- Use office hours and matter feedback to repair workflow fit.
- Train reviewers on when not to rely on the system.
- Give practice leadership a legible evidence readout.

SELECTION LENSES

LENS	STRONG SIGNAL	HOLD OR STOP SIGNAL
Outcome	Clear matter or client-service constraint.	Technology-first ask with no accountable outcome.
Knowledge	Authoritative, owned, accessible, maintainable sources.	Stale, fragmented, unowned, or prohibited content.
Authority	Lawyer review and escalation are explicit and workable.	Consequential judgment is implicitly delegated.
Evaluation	Representative task evidence can be assembled.	No credible way to detect harmful failure.
Adoption	Practice sponsor, users, and workflow insertion point exist.	Demo enthusiasm without a changed behavior path.
Value	Operational or client-service effect can be observed.	Usage volume is the only proposed measure.

DAY-90 LEADERSHIP READOUT

What shipped; what attorneys used; what failed; what was stopped; where knowledge blocked AI; where controls enabled speed; what is ready for practice reuse; and what leadership decision is needed next.

Scale the proven controls, not the local assumptions.

The fourth month converts learning into a managed practice - with clear ownership, reusable patterns, and honest limits.

PRIORITIES

Promote Move repeatable workflows into a practice pattern or cross-practice candidate only when evidence supports the treatment.	Bound Document legitimate practice, matter, jurisdiction, knowledge, and authority exceptions.	Maintain Name owners for content, technical performance, evaluation, support, and retirement.	Lead Coach managers, rebalance capacity, and surface decisions to the Senior Director, CIO, and firm leadership.
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DAY-120 OPERATING SYSTEM

MECHANISM	MINIMUM VIABLE STATE
Applied AI portfolio	One visible backlog with outcome, sponsor, owner, stage, dependency, evidence, and next decision.
Delivery standard	Reusable conventions for workflow framing, prompt/agent design, retrieval, evaluation, release, observation, and change control.
Applied AI Reporter	Monthly cross-practice decision forum and maintained record of prototype, practice, cross-practice, and firm-standard treatments.
Adoption system	Practice-sponsored demos, office hours, embedded learning, feedback, support, and manager coaching.
Leadership scorecard	Flow, quality, knowledge, authority/risk, adoption, value, reuse, and lifecycle signals with context.
Vendor posture	Build-vs-buy criteria, integration and security requirements, quality evidence, operating cost, dependency, and exit path.

WHAT I WOULD ASK LEADERSHIP TO DECIDE

Portfolio Which outcomes deserve concentrated capacity next, and which work should stop?	Authority Where should firm standards govern, and where should practice leadership retain explicit discretion?
Investment Which knowledge, platform, integration, evaluation, or adoption bottleneck limits value most?	Client service Where should Covington make its applied AI capability visible to clients, and with what evidence?

FIRST 120 DAYS - SUCCESS POSTURE

The team has a clearer mandate, practices see useful delivery rather than central ceremony, AI and knowledge decisions are connected, control partners enter early, leadership can see evidence and tradeoffs, and a small number of workflows have earned an explicit precedent treatment.